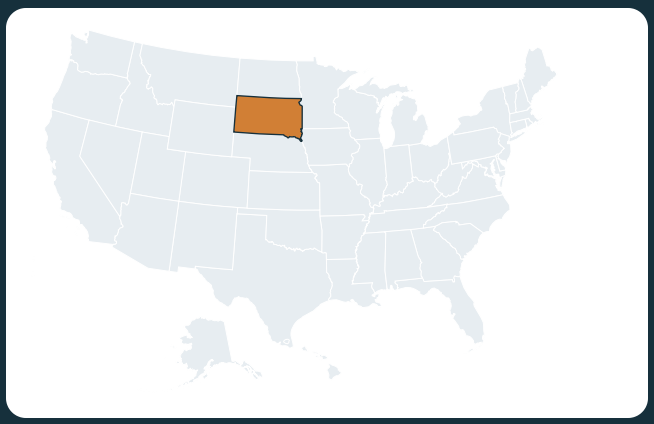
CYBER RESILIENCE · EXTERNAL ATTACK SURFACE

South Dakota

How exposed are the state's critical access hospitals from the outside?

70.6% of 17 assessed hospital domains sit in an elevated risk band (Critical or High)

National: 78.3% · mean score 66.7 vs 68.5 national (−1.8)



17
hospital domains assessed in South Dakota

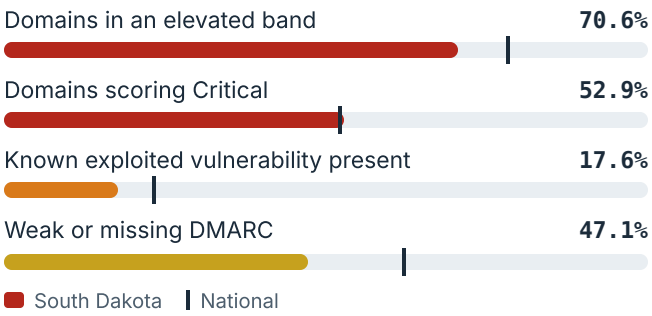
40
critical access hospitals located in the state

66.7
mean score · High band (0–100)

36th
most exposed of 42 reported states, by share elevated

South Dakota against the national picture

Bars are South Dakota; the black tick is the national figure across 977 domains.



How the 17 domains are distributed

Each domain is scored on its worst internet-facing machine.



DOMAINS WITH A FINDING IN	SD	US	DIFF
Vulnerabilities	41%	53%	-11 pts
Email authentication	59%	77%	-18 pts
Exposed services	59%	66%	-7 pts
Web application and DNS	82%	88%	-6 pts

THREE FIXES THAT MOVE THE NEEDLE

01
Enforce email authentication
Publish DMARC, read its reports, then move to p=reject. A DNS change: no purchase, no downtime. 47% of South Dakota domains are weak or missing here.

02
Close admin and database doors
Remote Desktop, SSH and database ports should not answer the internet. Put them behind a VPN or turn them off.

03
Retire forgotten records
Remove DNS records that point at services you no longer run, and patch or replace outdated web libraries.

How this was measured. Passive observation of what each hospital publishes to the internet: DNS, certificates, open ports and public web pages. Nothing was logged into or exploited. Vulnerabilities are checked against the CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog and FIRST EPSS, current to 2026-09-08; part of the scan data is older, so read the figures as a floor. Domain counts are not hospital counts: one health-system domain can carry several hospitals. No hospital is named; figures are aggregate only.

SureShield with BorderHawk.
Check any critical access hospital's band, or test your email security for free, on the SureShield critical access hospital site.

SureShield analysis · generated 23 October 2026